

Test	Pros	Cons
Flexible sigmoidoscopy	Fairly quick and safe Usually doesn't req...	Looks at only about a third of the colon ...
Colonoscopy	Can usually look at the entire colon Can ...	Can miss small polyps Full bowel prep n...
Double-contrast barium enema (DCBE)	Can usually see the entire colon Relativ...	Can miss small polyps Full bowel prep n...
CT colonography (virtual colonoscopy)	Fairly quick and safe Can usually see th...	Can miss small polyps Full bowel prep n...
Guaiac-based fecal occult blood test (gF...	No direct risk to the colon No bowel prep	Can miss many polyps and some cancer...